

My Lower-Risk Plan

Original worksheet by Sophia Cohon, PhD

Choose one practical step that makes your actual situation safer.

The situation I want to make safer

Match a risk with a step I am willing to take

What raises my risk?

☐ Using alone

☐ Unknown contents

☐ Mixing substances

☐ Using after a break

What could lower it?


☐ Someone able to help

☐ Naloxone nearby

☐ Drug checking

☐ Do not use that supply

☐ Avoid a risky mix

☐ Ask a pharmacist

☐ Plan for lower tolerance

☐ Seek medical advice

A negative fentanyl test does not prove a drug is safe. A period of using less or not using can lower tolerance. Avoid combining opioids with alcohol, benzodiazepines, or other sedating drugs.

Before
One step I choose



Support
Who / what can help



When
When I will use this step

Where naloxone is kept

Person / service and contact

If someone cannot wake up or is not breathing normally

Call 911

Give naloxone if available

Follow dispatcher instructions

Stay with the person until help arrives. Follow the naloxone product instructions. See the [overdose response card](#).

Withdrawal matters. If you may be physically dependent on alcohol or benzodiazepines, seek medical guidance before abruptly stopping.

My goals and support

Choose a step that fits the person's situation and priorities. Safer choices matter even when they are not ready to stop using.

A change I want to consider

☐ Make one part safer☐ Use less often☐ Avoid one risky mix☐ Ask about medication treatment☐ Counseling / peer support☐ Take a break or stop

Other risks or barriers: cravings, withdrawal, pain, housing, supplies...

What makes help easier to reach?

What I want to ask a clinician or pharmacist

Plan for a difficult moment

When my risk is likely to go up

The step I can take then

What people around me need to know about my location, naloxone, and calling for help

A plan reduces risk; it does not remove it. A remote check-in cannot provide immediate hands-on help. Drug checking has limits. Naloxone treats opioid overdose; emergency care is still needed. Discuss medication treatment, safer supplies, and withdrawal care with appropriate services.

About this worksheet. This original planning tool summarizes the guidance linked below. It is not a validated assessment or a copy of an external worksheet. Guidance checked September 29, 2026.

- CDC: [overdose response](#) · [fentanyl tests](#) · [mixing substances](#)
- SAMHSA: [Overdose Prevention and Response Toolkit](#)
- ASAM: [benzodiazepine tapering](#) · [alcohol withdrawal](#)